SUMMER 2019

SOCIAL MEDIA CAMPAIGN

MAYS BUSINESS SCHOOL

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Table of Contents

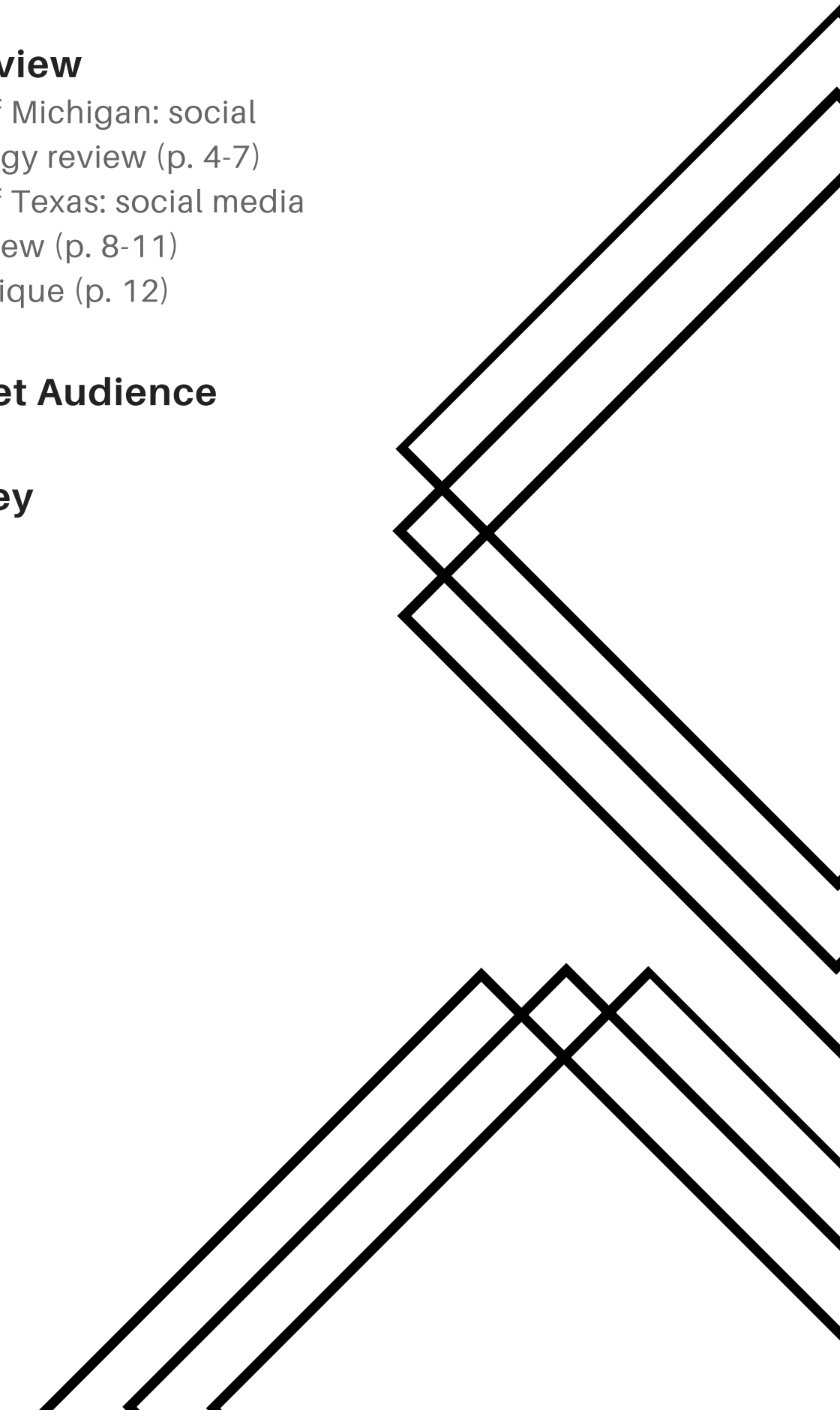
Part 1: Overview

- University of Michigan: social media strategy review (p. 4-7)
- University of Texas: social media strategy review (p. 8-11)
- Detailed critique (p. 12)

Part 2: Target Audience

Part 3: Survey

Appendix





Part 1: Overview

Part 1 of our report will provide an overview of how other universities use social media for information dissemination, and how this can be used as an example for Mays Business School. We will be focusing on Facebook and Instagram.

For our analysis, we will analyze the social media strategies of the University of Michigan's Ross School of Business and the University of Texas' McCombs School of Business. We will describe their posting frequency, tone, interactivity, and navigability. The merits and demerits of their social media approach will be highlighted as well.

Part 1 will conclude with a detailed critique of a post from the University of Texas.

The University of Michigan
ROSS SCHOOL of BUSINESS

UM has a designated team within their Department of Communications that specifically focuses on the planning and execution of their social media strategy.

"Our goal is to be a global pillar of excellence in social communications".

The University of Michigan believes that social media is "rooted in strategy and collaboration". While the goal of social media is to be interactive and engaging to the user, UM expresses in their Social Media Best Practices that this "does not negate the need to have associated goals, thoughtful design, and clear expectations for performance, accountability, and value added".

Their **Facebook** Strategy

32,857
FOLLOWERS

The Ross School of Business only posts to their Facebook page about 1-2 times per week. Their user interactivity is quite low, with an average of about 50 likes per post and only a few shares.

Their posts consist of content generated by Ross that highlights the accomplishments and offerings associated with the business school's students, faculty, and staff. They occasionally post articles from outside sources that they believe will interest their followers, but nothing that encourages user engagement.

Their Facebook posts have a common theme and tone of professional development and academia. Navigating through their Facebook page is clear and easy for the user. The menu bar on the left hand side of their profile page makes it easy for visitors to search for photos, videos, posts, etc.



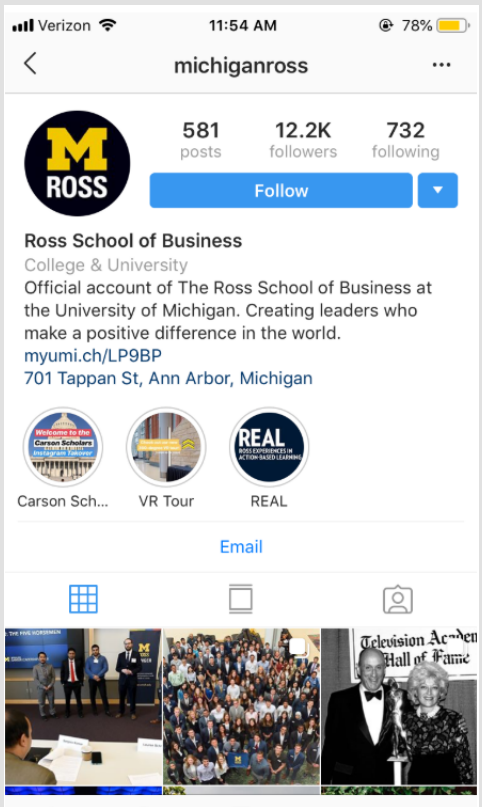
Their **Instagram** Strategy

"Social media is rooted in strategy and collaboration."- UM

The **Ross School of Business'** Instagram page uses the same posting frequency as their Facebook page by only posting 1-2 times per week.

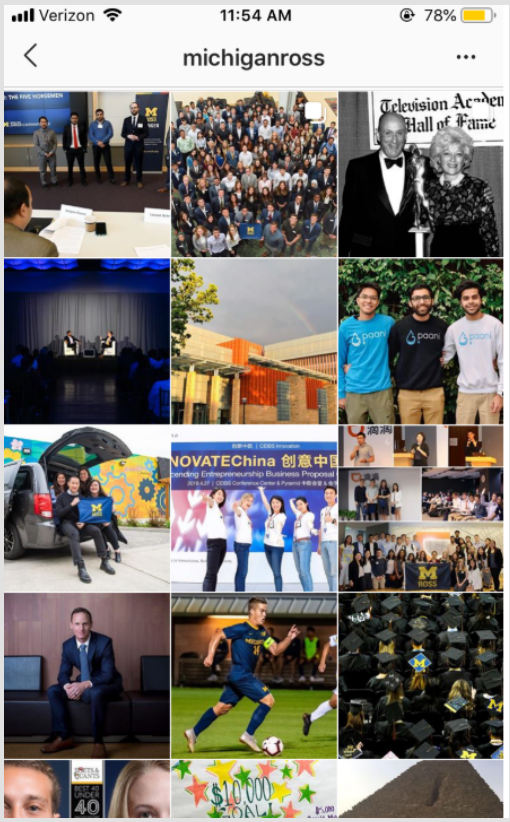
Their Instagram page follows the same trend of posting content that showcases student and staff accomplishments. However, Ross recognizes that Instagram is the preferred social media platform among college students, so they do make an attempt to incorporate student-generated content into their timeline.

Navigating their Instagram profile is very easy to do. Ross has added a menu feature to the top of their profile page that allows the user to select the specific content that they would like to view (pictured below).



12,200

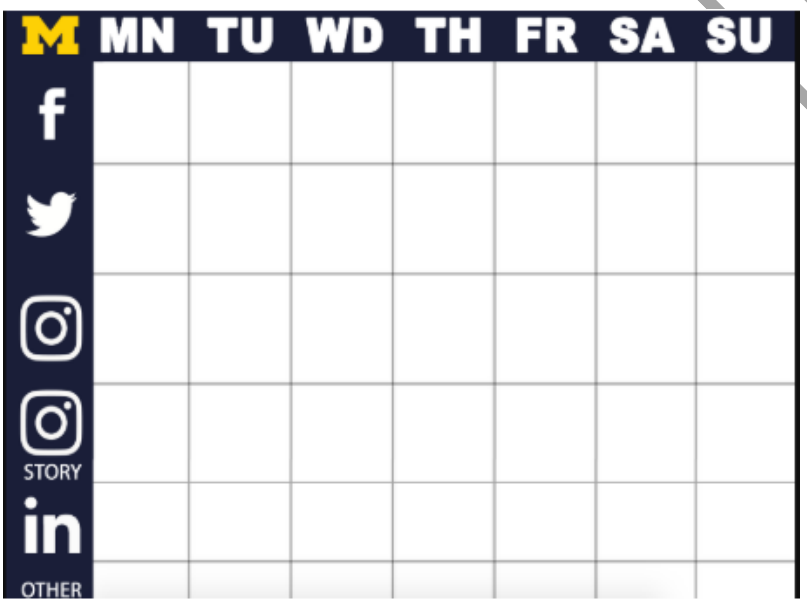
FOLLOWERS



Merits & Demerits

Merits

The University of Michigan excels at creating and highlighting information simply by including a broad level of organizational tactics across each social media platform with ease. By using content calendars (pictured to the right) for both Facebook and Instagram, UM is able to coordinate their posting effectively. Their dissemination of content is methodical, which is why they only post a couple of times a week. The University of Michigan states that people value organized content, using social media as a tool in its curation.



Demerits

The overall tone of Ross's social media platforms appeals more towards an older demographic, such as alumni. While they are successful in expressing their professionalism and academic achievements, this type of content does not necessarily grab the attention of their students. Especially with Instagram, Ross should try to follow in the footsteps of the main UM page by trying to be more aesthetic and appealing to a younger audience.

The University of Texas
McCOMBS SCHOOL of BUSINESS

"We aim to bring to life achievements of the Texas community. Integrate communications approach across channels. Engage audiences through calls to action and shareable content."- UT

set new standards
respect & ethics

elevate the brand
accuracy & honesty

create inspiring content
value & interest
personality

stay on strategy
transparency &
disclosure



Their **Facebook** Strategy

The McCombs School of Business is very active on social media and they understand that their content reaches a variety of audiences. In order to appeal to their 13,093 Facebook followers, McCombs posts 1-2 times per day. However, their follower interactivity is not very impressive. Their content includes alumni and student accomplishments, research articles, relevant current events, and campus resources. Overall, their posts are still restricted to promoting the prestige of the school.

While their page is not strictly comprised of university-generated content, there is still a common theme of professionalism and academia. The user demographics of Facebook tend to lean towards an older age group, so UT and McComb's aim to maintain their "higher end" image.

Their home page is very easy to navigate, with a user-friendly menu bar on the left side for narrowing down searches. All links to original posts that McCombs might share are also provided in the caption for the user's convenience.

Their **Instagram** Strategy

6,329

FOLLOWERS

The McCombs School of Business uses their Instagram platform to focus more on the achievements of their students. McCombs recognizes that Instagram is the preferred social media platform for their students, so they appeal to this audience by posting more student-generated content. While their timeline still has a sense of professionalism and scholarship, the stream of posts on their Instagram has a more relaxed feel and tone (pictured below).

Compared to their Facebook page, McCombs scales back the posting frequency on their Instagram to just once every 2 days. However, the user interactivity is much higher on their Instagram even though they do not post as often. Their most recent posts have received upwards of 200 likes.

McCombs keeps their captions simple and to the point. Any hashtags that are used in the caption are consistent across all of their social media platforms in order to maximize that hashtag's engagement.
Navigating their Instagram profile is made easy with a menu feature that categorizes their posts for easy searching.







Merits & Demerits

Merits

McCombs' Instagram strategy does a great job of blending professional and student-generated content at an appropriate frequency. The aesthetic of the timeline is methodical and hosts a variety of posts that keep their followers interested and engaged. They manage to create a more relaxed social media platform for their students, while also highlighting their academic successes. McComb's Instagram account serves as a great example of how business school does not just have to be about business.

Demerits

McCombs' greatest demerit in their social media strategy is the extreme formality of their Facebook page. While it is clear that their posts are geared towards an older demographic, it seems quite dull due to a lack of variety and excitement . Although this approach successfully reflects the university’s prestige, this type of content might be the reason why their Facebook page does not receive a lot of engagement and interactivity from their followers.

Post Critique



This Instagram post from the McCombs School of Business showcases several of their students painting a mural alongside a local Austin artist, Karen Maness.

The caption includes multiple hashtags and tags in order to maximize their reach and engage their followers. Using #MondayMotivation in the caption not only aligns with Instagram trends and appeals to a social media- savvy audience, but also serves as a token of encouragement.

This post is a great representation of how McCombs uses their Instagram platform to combine professional development with creativity, inspired by their very own students. Collaborating with a local artist and the Texas Performing Arts Center emphasizes that business school can also be a creative and artistic process.

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